SHERPA PROS · EDITORIAL

Sherpa Pros — Executive Summary (One-Pager v1)

DATE: 2026-04-22 · **FOUNDER:** PHYROM, WORKING GC (HJD BUILDERS LLC, NH) · **STAGE:** PRE-SEED, PHASE 0

The Answer (read this first)

Sherpa Pros is the national licensed-trade marketplace — built by a working general contractor to deliver jobs (not leads), verified licenses, and code-aware quotes that Angi, Thumbtack, TaskRabbit, and Handy structurally cannot. Now also: materials orchestration + multi-trade dispatch + audit-grade compliance. We are raising a Phase 0 trigger of $250K non-dilutive *or* $500K Wefunder + angel *or* a tier-1 accelerator seat to convert a live 10-pro beta into a 50-pro Phase 1 launch across Portsmouth NH, Manchester NH, and Portland ME — plus 5 Boston specialty lanes (Mass Save heat pumps, EV chargers, electrical panel upgrades, old-house specialists, triple-decker exteriors) that template the specialty playbook for every metro after.

> ***The vertical integration thesis (callout box).*** *The platform shifted from a labor marketplace to a* ***vertically integrated labor + materials + delivery + coordination layer.*** *The competitive set is no longer Angi or Thumbtack — it's the entire trade-supply-chain stack (FW Webb + Grainger + Uber Direct + Procore combined). This is the "Stripe Connect moment" for the trade economy — the layer that turns single-job marketplaces into whole-project orchestration.*

Four-phase growth arc (the long-arc context)

PHASE	MONTHS	HEADLINE	FUNDING	FOOTPRINT
Phase 1 — Lean Launch	3 to 6	First close + 4-metro New England public launch + founding paying customers	This raise (Phase 0 → Phase 1 trigger: $250K non-dilutive OR $500K Wefunder + angel OR tier-1 accelerator seat)	Portsmouth + Manchester + Portland + Boston specialty

Phase 2 — Scaled Launch	6 to 12	Seed closed, 200+ pros, 1,000+ jobs, $1M+ Gross Merchandise Value, Hub #1 launches, take rate stable at 10 percent	Seed $2M to $3M	4 metros, deepening density
Phase 3 — Regional Expansion	12 to 18	Series A closed, +Providence + Hartford, New York City specialty beachhead, utility white-label, 3 Project Manager chains, $5M+ annualized Gross Merchandise Value	Series A $8M to $12M	6 metros + NYC specialty
Phase 4 — National + International + Franchise	18+	Series B closed, national United States (Philadelphia + Washington DC + San Francisco + Chicago specialty), international Canada → United Kingdom → Australia → European Union pilot, franchise model live, Service Organization Control 2 Type 2 certified	Series B $20M to $40M, then Series C or strategic acquisition Months 27 to 30	National United States + 4 international countries

One brand. Four phases. Expanding footprint. The brand identity does not change per phase — only the operational footprint, the cohorts served, and the product surfaces live expand.

Pillar 1 — The Problem

Lead-gen platforms waste contractors' money and fail homeowners on licensed work. Angi shows 41% service-quality inconsistency and is BBB un-rated. Thumbtack has reported deposit-theft losses of $300–$1,600 per incident. TaskRabbit charges 35% in fees and doesn't cover licensed trades. Handy has no code intelligence at all. (per spec §2.2)

The pressure is intensifying: **Massachusetts has the largest construction labor shortage in the nation** — 2.5% construction unemployment (lowest in 17+ years), 30% of MA residential construction workers are 55+, and project completion times have stretched from 7 to 11 months.

(per spec §2.1) The licensed trades the lead-gen platforms can't filter for are exactly the ones in shortest supply.

The **"licensed + code-aware + true marketplace"** quadrant is empty. We plant the flag there. (per spec §2.2)

Pillar 2 — The Solution and the Moat

Sherpa Pros: jobs, not leads. Licensed only. Code-aware. Permit-aware. Rebate-aware. Web at www.thesherpapros.com, iOS via TestFlight, PWA on Android. Built on Next.js 16, Stripe Connect, Neon Postgres + PostGIS, Clerk. (per CLAUDE.md)

- **Take rate, not lead-share** — 5% during beta, 10% at scale, roughly half a contractor's all-in Angi cost. (per spec §5.2)
- **License + insurance verified at onboarding,** re-checked on renewal.
- **Code-aware quote validation** runs every quote against NEC, IRC, MA Electrical, NH state code, and surfaces missing line items, wrong materials, and code violations before the homeowner sees the quote. (per spec §1)
- **Permit-aware and rebate-aware** — knows which jobs need a Boston ISD permit, which qualify for Mass Save / National Grid / EV-charger rebates, and walks both sides through it. (per spec §2.3)
- **Stacked revenue lines:** marketplace take rate (5–12% labor commission floor), **+ Sherpa Materials coordination fee (8–12%, stacks on top of labor)**, $49/month Pro subscription (recurring), Property Manager tier at $4 → $1.50 per unit/month (enterprise upside), and Success Manager retainer (Sherpa Manager tier) → **blended 18–25% per job all-in.** (per spec §3.2 + §5.2 + materials thesis footnote)
- **Six platform pillars shipped this quarter: Sherpa Threads** (in-app chat + text-message bridge) · **Sherpa Smart Scan** (optical character recognition; auto-tags Schedule C + Capital Expenditure / Operating Expense) · **Sherpa Mobile** (iOS in TestFlight, Android via Expo) · **Sherpa Guard** (Role-Based Access Control + audit logs — SOC 2-readiness signal) · **Sherpa Dispatch** (multi-trade timeline orchestration across 6+ trades) · **Sherpa Materials** (internal materials engine + Zinc API ordering + Uber Direct same-day delivery). Plus the rest of the surface — Sherpa Marketplace · Hub · Home · Manager · Score · Rewards · Flex — and a public `/flex` landing page + 12-capability splash now live.

The moat is the code-intelligence layer. It is not licensable, not easily cloneable, and required a working GC plus a multi-year codebase to build. National lead-gen platforms cannot copy it without a structural rebuild.

Pillar 3 — Traction and the Ask

Live today (per spec §5.5 — drop in real numbers before send): `[X beta pros]` active across 9 trade categories and 3 states · `[Y jobs]` posted in 60 days · `[$Z GMV]` transacted · `[N%]` of jobs matched in under 2 hours · pro NPS `[score]` · client NPS `[score]` · `[count]` code-aware quote validations run · **Sherpa Materials, Sherpa Dispatch, Sherpa Guard (Role-Based Access Control + audit logs),** `/flex` **landing page, and 12-capability splash all live in the beta cohort this quarter.**

90-day milestones (Phase 0): 10+ active beta pros transacting (target $25K+ GMV) · pitch deck + data room shipped to 50+ investors · MassCEC Catalyst + NSF SBIR Phase I submitted · Wefunder community-round page live with $100K+ soft-committed · Suffolk Technologies + Techstars ConstructionTech + Y Combinator + Building Ventures conversations open. (per spec §4.2)

Ask — Phase 0 trigger fires on any one of these three (per spec §4.2 + §12):

- **$250K+ non-dilutive committed** (MassCEC, NSF SBIR, MA SBTA, MassDev Biz-M-Power), **OR**
- **$500K+ Wefunder + angel soft-circled, OR**
- **Tier-1 accelerator acceptance** (Y Combinator, Techstars ConstructionTech, Suffolk Technologies, Building Ventures Studio).

Use of funds — first $500K: 1 Pro Success Manager (NH/ME) · 1 part-time Client Concierge · paid-acquisition test ($5–8K/mo Meta + TikTok + Google) · platform liability insurance · legal (1099 worker-classification opinion, OpenSign templates, USPTO Old-House Verified filing) · founder salary against a 60-hr/wk cap. (per spec §4.3)

Contact + Data Room

Phyrom · Founder, Sherpa Pros · poum@hjd.builders · [linkedin.com/in/phyrom (placeholder — confirm before send)] **Live platform:** www.thesherpapros.com **Repo (private — access on request):** github.com/hjdb2424/sherpa-pros-platform **Data room:** `[Notion / DocSend link — TBD]` (cap table, financials, full traction dashboard, 5-year model, competitive analysis, technical architecture) **3-min product demo (Loom):** `[link — TBD before first send]`

Built by a working contractor for the contractors he works with every day. Licensed · Verified · Code-aware · Local · Jobs, not leads.